



OSI 2011

Resonated With the Power of Open Source

FOSS is not only about providing freely modifiable source code to others, but also about transforming mindsets in order to build 'open' communities that work towards strengthening the open source ecosystem. The recently concluded Open Source India 2011 was aimed at achieving this goal.

At this year's Open Source India, a.k.a. OSI, FOSS enthusiasts recognised and hailed the event as an ideal platform for interaction and the exchange of knowledge related to Linux and open source. Over 3,000 people attended the event across the three days, which bears testimony to the fact that FOSS has strengthened its roots within the country.

OSI Days, formerly known as LinuxAsia, was first organised in 2003, with an aim to celebrate the spirit of open source and increase its adoption throughout Asia. In alignment with this goal, this year's agenda was to bridge the gap between the community and industry, and to promote the adoption and use of open source software among Indian businesses and developers.

The event was organised by FOSII (Forum for Open Source Initiatives in India), the EFY Group, *LINUX For You* magazine and OSSCube. The event was sponsored by Google, VMware, Oracle, Microsoft and Novell.

Over 70 talks were delivered and 12 workshops conducted by eminent national and international experts across the three days of the event. While we will shortly post more updates related to the event on osidays.com and linuxforu.com, here's a brief round-up of what happened over three exciting days.

FOSS in India is touching new heights

Regunath Balasubramanian, principal architect of the Government of India's UIDAI project, one of the eminent speakers at OSI and also the guest of honour, affirmed that with projects like *Aadhaar*, FOSS in India has scaled to a new level. He shared details about how the project is making use of OSS, like the Hadoop platform, Hive, Zoo Keeper, MYSQL, MongoDB DB, Tom Cat, Spring and Mule (for more on the *Aadhaar* project, read the case study published on Page 20).

However, Balasubramanian agreed that FOSS has still a long way to go. "Open source is not yet a mass movement in India. People want to hear success stories and replicate them. They need to hear stories about FOSS professionals earning very high salaries. OSI Days 2011 offers a good platform for us to share such success stories. The continuous use of OSS in *Aadhaar* can promote the use of open source in other e-governance projects, and promote open source in India for large and complex systems," he added.

Microsoft and Oracle go 'open' about OSS

A few visitors were intrigued by the presence of Microsoft at OSI. However, they found the answers to their doubts in the keynote presented



Nimhans Convention Centre, Bengaluru, the venue for the three-day 'open' convention.



The event's registration desk—all set to welcome open source fans



The event witnessed the participation of thousands of attendees over the three days



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